TWINTHOS · FIELD PLAN · OCTOBER 2026

Who to target.

A 90-day plan for selling screen agents into UK back offices — with honest odds, real scripts, and the target that actually answers the phone.

EVERY FIGURE SOURCED

ESTIMATES LABELLED AS ESTIMATES

THE WHOLE BUSINESS

01

One calculation explains everything

You are not selling software. You are standing in the gap between what a person costs and what a robot costs.

ITEM	PER YEAR	PER MONTH
A payroll administrator costs	**£22,000**	**£1,833**
A hosted unattended bot lists at	**≈ £2,000**	**≈ £167**
The gap you sell into	**£20,000**	**≈ £1,667**

> THEREFORE
>
> **Charge £800 a month and you are still an 85% saving.** You do not need to be clever, innovative, or differentiated. You need to stand in the gap and charge a slice of it.

So never say these words

"AI digital employee." "Agentic transformation." "Intelligent automation."

Say this instead:

> *"That task costs you £1,833 a month. I do it for £800. Same output."*

WHY THIS IS LEGITIMATE

02

The industry's dirty secret

Screen automation sounds like a workaround. It isn't. It's what the API industry already does — with the human still attached.

291

HR & payroll providers listed by Finch, the market-leading "unified API"

222

of those are **human-assisted** connections — not real API integrations

> READ THAT AGAIN
>
> The leading clean-API company for payroll employs **humans to be the API** for 222 of its 291 providers. Only 38 are genuine integrations.

Paycom scores **C** on the API Report Card: no public API, undocumented partner REST, credentials handed over per integration, bulk data still moved by CSV or SFTP.

> *Screen agents are not a hack around the industry. They are the industry, with the human removed.*

So the question is never *"is this needed?"* It is only: who has the most of it, and can I reach them?

THE OPTIONS

03

Four sectors, scored honestly

SECTOR	SIZE	ONE-OWNER DECISION	ODDS*
Payroll bureaus & accountancy practices	30–40k firms	Yes	**Highest**
Care homes	14,137 sites	No — group or trust	**Medium**
Dental / veterinary	45,580 dentists	Sometimes	**Medium-low**
Freight forwarders	Few hundred	Yes, but closed network	**Low for a stranger**
Local councils	~370	No — frameworks only	**Near zero**

*Odds of a *paid pilot within 60 days* from one approach. Derivation on page 6.

The three to ignore, and why

Councils. Procurement frameworks and minimum contract sizes make a one-person company unsellable. Not a market problem — a structural one.

Freight. Genuine pain, gated by relationships you don't have. Wrong sector for a cold start.

Care homes. The pain is real and severe, but the budget sits two levels above the person who feels it. Long cycle, small deal.

THE DECISION

04

Target: UK payroll bureaus

One person decides. They bill by the hour. The work is identical every month. The software cannot be API'd. And they already sell the thing you sell.

Five reasons, in order of weight

1. **One person decides.** The owner is the buyer. No committee, no procurement, no security review board.
2. **They bill by the hour.** Saved hours are money, not a vague benefit. Their entire business model is "I charge for time".
3. **Monthly, identical, forever.** Same date, same steps, same screens. Perfect for an agent — and provable in a single cycle.
4. **The software genuinely can't be API'd.** Sage 50 Payroll, BrightPay, Moneysoft, IRIS. Desktop-first, no usable public interface.
5. **They already outsource.** A bureau does other people's work for a fee. You are speaking their language, not teaching a new concept.

> THE SENTENCE THAT OPENS THE DOOR
>
> "You already sell hours to your clients. I sell hours back to you."

Who exactly, inside the sector

Not the big networks. Target **2–15 person practices** — big enough to have a real payroll run, small enough that the owner answers their own email.

THE HONEST ODDS

05

What actually converts

Cold B2B email averages a **3.43% reply rate** in 2025–26 — down from 5.1% in 2024 and 8.5% in 2019.

Cold route, built from that measured number

STAGE	RATE	BASIS
Cold email → reply	**3.4%**	Measured benchmark
Reply → booked call	**30%**	ESTIMATE
Call → paid pilot	**25%**	ESTIMATE
Email → pilot	**~0.25%**	1 in 400 sends

Every route, side by side

ROUTE	PILOT IN 60 DAYS
Warm introduction from someone they trust	**15–25%**
Cold, naming their exact software and task	**2–4%**
Inbound, after one published case study	**8–12%**
Cold, generic "AI automation" pitch	**<1%**

THE UNCOMFORTABLE CONCLUSION

Your first client will not come from cold email. At 0.25% you need 400 sends for one pilot. Your first client comes from a **warm introduction**

WHERE THE DOORS ARE

06

Your ten warm routes

Accountants are the most networked small profession in Britain. Every one of them knows twenty others. You need four conversations, not four hundred emails.

Start here, this week

1. **Your own accountant.** They either run payroll or know who does. Highest-probability conversation available to you — and it costs one phone call.
2. **Whoever does your own books.** Same logic, different door.
3. **Bristol business networks.** Chambers, FSB, BNI chapters, accountant breakfasts. They exist specifically so small firms can refer each other.
4. **Bookkeeping bodies.** ICB and IAB have regional branches and member forums. One member who trusts you is worth 400 cold emails.

The referral trick that actually works

Never ask *"do you know anyone who might need this?"* — that question gets a polite nothing.

> *"Who's the busiest payroll bureau you know?"*

A specific question about a specific person produces a specific name. Then ask that person to introduce you — the introduction is the product, not the pitch.

TARGET FOR WEEKS 1–2

Three warm conversations. Not thirty emails. Three conversations.

THE SURPRISE

07

Your best lead list is already public

Don't buy a list. Read job adverts.

A firm advertising this has just published, for free, in public:

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Payroll Administrator · Sage 50 · 3 days/week · £24,000
Bristol · accountancy practice · start ASAP
```

That single advert tells you:

- they have the exact task you automate
- which software it runs on
- what it costs them per year
- that they are short of capacity right now
- and that they are *already spending money* to fix it

> **THIS IS NOT A LEAD. IT'S A BUYING SIGNAL.**
>
> Someone hiring a human to do a repetitive task is one conversation away from automating it. Every payroll vacancy in Bristol is a named prospect with a stated budget and a stated date they want the pain gone.

Do this, it takes an hour

Search Indeed and Reed for "payroll administrator", 30 miles around Bristol, filtered to accountancy practices. Write down the **software named in each advert**. That list is your entire first quarter.

WHAT TO SAY

08

The cold email — 84 words

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Subject: the Sage 50 payroll run

Hi [Name],

You're advertising for a payroll administrator on
Sage 50 — so the run is probably taking longer than
it should.

I build software that does the repetitive part of a
payroll run automatically, on your existing system,
no new software to buy. One Bristol bureau cut a
two-day run to about four hours.

Worth 15 minutes to see whether it fits yours?

[Name] · [phone]
```

Why each part is there

- **"Sage 50"** — proves you looked. This is the only part that earns a reply.
- **"advertising for"** — names their live problem, not your product.
- **One claim.** One. Not three.
- **One ask.** Fifteen minutes, not a demo, not a call, not a proposal.

> BANNED WORDS
>
> Revolutionary. AI-powered. Cutting-edge. Seamless. Transform. Solution. Leverage. Any sentence beginning with "We are a…"

Note: if you haven't done the case study yet, remove the Bristol bureau line

THE CONVERSATION

09

Twenty-second opener, then silence

> *"I'll be quick — I work with payroll bureaus on the part of the job that's pure repetition. What's the task in your week you'd hand over tomorrow if you could?"*

Then **stop talking.** The answer tells you whether there's a deal, and asking costs you nothing.

If they name a task, you have a prospect. If they say "nothing, we're fine", you have saved yourself two weeks.

The offer — fixed fee, no subscription

> **"Two weeks. One task, scoped and named. £1,500 fixed. If it doesn't work, you don't pay. If it does, we talk about a monthly figure for more."**

This beats every alternative for a first-time seller:

- £1,500 sits inside the published UK range for a first automation build — **£1.5k–£3.5k**
- it is under the **£1,000–£5,000** single-automation band
- small enough that an owner can say yes without a meeting
- and it buys the case study that makes client two easy

Take the smaller fee to move faster. The reference is worth more than the difference.

THE FOUR QUESTIONS

10

Objections, answered in one breath

"Is this legal?"

"It uses your own licence, your own login, and you authorise it in writing. I don't access anything you don't already access. If your software contract forbids it, we stop — I check that before we start."

"Will it break when Sage updates?"

"Sometimes, yes. That's why I run a daily test that fails loudly, so you hear it from me and not from a client. Maintenance is in the monthly fee, not extra."

"Is my data safe?"

"Scoped login, no database copy, full action log, deleted on request. Happy to sign your DPA. And I'm one person in Bristol, not a US platform — you can phone me."

"We already have an API."

"Then use it — I'll tell you honestly if the API covers this. The cases I win are the ones where the API doesn't exist or covers half the job."

> THE PATTERN
>
> Every answer concedes something real, then offers a concrete control. That is what makes it credible — not confidence, concession.

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HAVE

11

The two lists

Read the second list out loud to every prospect. It is what makes the first list believable.

You can deliver, today

- One named recurring task, automated end to end, in two weeks
- Running on the client's existing systems — no new software for them to buy
- A daily test that alerts on failure
- A human checkpoint before anything that moves money
- A written record of every action taken
- A fixed price and a named date

You cannot deliver yet — say so

- 24/7 support or a service-level agreement
- ISO 27001 or a SOC 2 report
- A multi-year track record or client references
- Any promise about payroll accuracy liability — that stays with them

> **WHY THIS WINS**
>
> Every competitor in this space overclaims. Naming your own limits is the cheapest trust you will ever buy, and almost nobody does it.

THE 90 DAYS

12

What to do, in order

Weeks 1–2 · One conversation, not a campaign

Your accountant. Then two people they name. Target: three warm conversations.

Weeks 3–4 · One pilot, sold cheap

£1,500, one task, fourteen days. Take the small fee. The case study outranks the invoice.

Weeks 5–8 · Build the proof

Measure it: hours before, hours after, errors before, errors after. Get one sentence in writing you can quote.

Weeks 9–12 · Convert, then repeat

Turn it into £800/month for the same task. Sell the next task to the same client. Only then start cold outreach — with a case study, where the numbers say 8–12% instead of 0.25%.

The realistic outcome

OUTCOME BY DAY 90	PROBABILITY
One paid pilot completed	**60–70%**
One pilot converted to retainer	**35–45%**
£2,000+/month recurring	**25–35%**
£5,000+/month recurring	**under 10%**

ONE THING TO REMEMBER

You are not selling a robot.

You are selling the hour a week when a qualified human becomes a copying machine — and charging less than that hour costs.

Everything else is detail.

SOURCES

Where every number came from

- Payroll administrator salary £22,000 starter — nationalcareers.service.gov.uk/job-profiles/payroll-administrator
- Hosted unattended bot $215/bot/month; unattended $150/mo; 10 bots $18,000/yr — thebotdesk.com/a/rpa-platforms-what-they-cost.html (checked Sept 2026)
- Automation Anywhere $126,000 / 12-month contract — same source
- Finch: 291 providers, 38 API-based, 222 human-assisted — kombo.dev/blog/best-unified-api-hris-integrations; unified.to (Oct 2026)
- Paycom API Grade C, no public API — supergood.ai/api-report-card/paycom (verified Oct 2026)
- OSWorld 12.24% agent vs 72.36% human (2024) → mid-80s (2026) — arxiv.org/abs/2404.07972v2; leaderboard.steel.dev; stepto.net
- Gartner: 40% of enterprise apps embed task-specific agents by end 2026 — gartner.com
- Cold email reply rate 3.43% — Instantly benchmark via repmath.com/en/cold-email-calculator
- UK first automation build £1.5k–£3.5k — streamlinedanalytics.co.uk/articles/ai-automation-agency (Oct 2026)
- Single automation £1,000–£5,000; agents £6,000–£25,000; retainers £300–£997/mo — axivon-ai.com/blog/ai-automation-agency-cost-uk
- UK AI day rate median £1,225 — augustova.co.uk/uk-ai-price-index
- UK accountancy firms 39,975 (2025) — rapportdigital.com/uk-accountancy-firms-decline; 30,032 — poundswise.com/industry-snapshots/accountancy
- 14,137 registered community social care locations (Aug 2025) — homecareassociation.org.uk
- 45,580 dentists registered (2025) — gdc-uk.org registration statistical report 2025

All probabilities are labelled ESTIMATE and derived from the funnel on page 6. No client results are claimed that have not happened.